SharePoint Online

System Administrator's Management Guide

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> **SharePoint Online is Microsoft's cloud-based collaboration platform** that provides team sites, document libraries, intranets, and content management capabilities. As a sysadmin, you manage site collections, permissions, governance policies, and integration with other Microsoft 365 services.

What is SharePoint Online?

SharePoint Online is a web-based collaborative platform that allows teams to create websites, store and share documents, manage workflows, and build custom applications. Unlike OneDrive which is for personal storage, SharePoint is designed for team collaboration and organizational content management.

SharePoint Online Structure:

- Tenant (Organization Level)
- Site Collections (Department/Project Level)
- Sites (Team/Topic Level)
- Lists & Libraries (Content Storage)
- Items & Documents (Individual Files)

Types of SharePoint Sites

Team Sites
Collaboration spaces for teams with document libraries and lists

Communication Sites
Publishing sites for sharing news and information

Hub Sites
Connect related sites for unified navigation and branding

Root Site
Organization's main SharePoint site and intranet

Classic Sites
Legacy SharePoint sites with traditional features

Microsoft 365 Groups
Team sites connected to Groups with Teams integration

Core Administrative Tasks

Site Collection Management

- Create and configure site collections
- Manage site collection administrators
- Monitor storage usage and quotas
- Configure site collection features

Permissions & Security

- Configure site-level permissions
- Manage SharePoint groups and roles
- Set up conditional access policies
- Control external sharing settings

- Handle site lifecycle management
- Implement data loss prevention (DLP)

Content & Governance

- Configure content types and metadata
- Set up retention and compliance policies
- Manage term store and taxonomy
- Configure information management policies
- Handle eDiscovery and legal holds

Integration & Apps

- Manage SharePoint app catalog
- Configure Power Platform integration
- Set up hybrid connectivity
- Manage third-party integrations
- Configure search and navigation

Sharing and External Access

- **External Sharing:** Control if and how users can share with external parties
- **Guest Access:** Manage external user accounts and their permissions
- **Anonymous Links:** Configure if "Anyone" links are allowed
- **Link Expiration:** Set automatic expiration for sharing links
- **Domain Restrictions:** Limit sharing to specific domains
- **Sharing Auditing:** Monitor and report on sharing activities

Bottom Line: SharePoint Online serves as the collaboration backbone for Microsoft 365. Focus on proper site structure, governance policies, and security controls to enable effective teamwork while maintaining organizational compliance and data protection.

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